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Quickstart and authentication

TaskFlow offers a fictional JSON REST API at https://api.taskflow.example/v1. Endpoints, credentials, and responses in this guide are illustrative and not live.

Access requirements

API access is available to Starter, Pro, and Business workspaces. Free does not include API access. A workspace Owner or Admin creates an API token in Settings > Developer > API tokens. Tokens inherit the creator's workspace role and project access; they do not bypass permissions.

Authenticate with a bearer token

```
Authorization: Bearer tf_demo_your_token
```

Send application/json content where relevant, and use HTTPS for every request. Never expose tokens in public source code. A revoked token immediately returns HTTP 401.

Get projects

```
GET https://api.taskflow.example/v1/projects
```

A successful response has HTTP 200 and a JSON object: {"data": [{"id": "prj_123", "name": "Website Launch"}], "next_cursor": null}. Private projects that a token owner cannot access are omitted.

Pagination

List endpoints accept limit (default 25, maximum 100) and cursor. The API returns next_cursor when another page is available. Cursor values are opaque and should not be modified.

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Projects and tasks endpoints

All timestamps use ISO 8601 UTC and all identifiers are stable strings; examples intentionally use harmless demo IDs.

Core endpoints

Method / path	Purpose
GET /projects	List accessible projects
POST /projects	Create project (Owner/Admin or enabled Member)
GET /projects/{id}/tasks	List project tasks
POST /projects/{id}/tasks	Create a task
PATCH /tasks/{id}	Update task fields

Create a task

```
POST /v1/projects/prj_123/tasks
```

```
{"title":"QA landing page","status":"to_do","priority":"high"}
```

A valid create request returns HTTP 201 with the newly created task. A missing title returns 422 VALIDATION_ERROR. An unknown or inaccessible project may return 404 NOT_FOUND to avoid revealing private project existence.

Idempotency

For POST requests, include an Idempotency-Key header containing a unique string. TaskFlow caches the result for 24 hours; repeating the same key with a different payload returns 409 IDEMPOTENCY_CONFLICT.

Field enums

The task status API values are to_do, in_progress, blocked, and done. Priority values are low, medium, high, and urgent. The web app displays human-readable equivalents.

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Exports, limits, and webhooks

Export entitlements differ from standard API access. Do not assume that Starter API access includes API export.

API export availability

POST /v1/projects/{id}/exports is available to Pro and Business only, with format csv or json. Free and Starter receive HTTP 403 FEATURE_NOT_INCLUDED for API exports. Starter may still export CSV through the web UI (Plans & Billing, page 2).

```
POST /v1/projects/prj_123/exports
{"format":"csv"}
```

A valid request returns HTTP 202 and an export job ID. Poll GET /v1/exports/{job_id}; when complete, the download_url expires 24 hours after job creation. XLSX is never an API export format.

Rate limits

Plan	Requests per minute	API export jobs per day
Free	No API access	0
Starter	60	0
Pro	300	50
Business	1,200	200

A rate limit violation returns HTTP 429 RATE_LIMITED with Retry-After in seconds. Rate limits apply per workspace across all tokens. Standard requests and export requests both count toward the request-per-minute limit.

Webhooks

Pro and Business can subscribe to task.created, task.updated, and project.archived events. Webhook payloads include an event ID and UTC timestamp. Validate X-TaskFlow-Signature using the shared secret. TaskFlow retries failed deliveries after 1, 5, and 20 minutes.

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Error contracts and recovery

Errors use a stable envelope to support applications and actionable RAG troubleshooting.

Error response schema

```
{"error":{"code":"RATE_LIMITED","message":"Too many requests"}}
```

Common codes

HTTP	Error code	Recommended action
400	BAD_REQUEST	Check JSON and required parameters.
401	UNAUTHORIZED	Verify token or generate a new token.
403	FEATURE_NOT_INCLUDED	Check plan entitlements before retrying.
404	NOT_FOUND	Confirm resource ID and access.
409	IDEMPOTENCY_CONFLICT	Use a new key for a changed payload.
422	VALIDATION_ERROR	Correct invalid field values.
429	RATE_LIMITED	Wait Retry-After seconds, then retry.

Retry guidance

Retry HTTP 429 and 5xx responses with exponential backoff and jitter. Do not retry 401 or 403 without changing credentials or entitlements. Use idempotency keys for mutating requests that may be repeated.

Further reading

Troubleshooting, page 2 contains practical auth and rate-limit diagnostics. Plans & Billing, page 2 documents UI versus API export eligibility. Release Notes, page 3 gives the date API export support was launched.